



Game Development with the Unity Cross-Platform Game Engine

Project Checkpoint 1.2

Sad Guys

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1. Game Overview

Title: MindShift

Genre : 2D Platformer / Puzzle game

Target Audience: Players who enjoy solving puzzles, platformers and physic-based gameplay

Platform: PC (Unity)

2. Game Objective

The main objective of the game is to escape the research facility using telekinetic abilities. Players must manipulate objects in the environment to solve puzzles, unlock new areas, and progress through levels while avoiding or defeating enemies.

Success condition:

- Successfully making it to the end of all levels and escaping the facility.

Failure conditions:

- Player death (caused by touching enemies, projectiles, environmental hazards)

Progression Systems:

- The game will be separated into 3 to 5 levels which increase in difficulty
- New mechanics are introduced as the player progresses (1 per level)
- The puzzles become more complicated as new mechanics are introduced

3. MDA Framework

3.1. Mechanics

Player Controls:

- Movement:
 - Move left and right (A key/left arrow & D key/ right arrow)
 - Jump (W key/ up arrow/ space)
- Telekinesis:

- Hold Left mouse button while mouse is over an object to move object (mouse)
- Release left mouse button to drop object (mouse)
- Move mouse to reposition object (mouse)
- Hold Right click while holding object to charge throw (mouse)
- Release right click while holding object to throw (mouse)
- Interaction:
 - Press E to interact with objects (read sign, activate switch)

Difficulty system:

- Three difficulties (Easy, Intermediate, Hard)
- Decides the players' health
- Decides the speed of the enemies

Scoring System:

- Timer: Displays the time it took to complete level
- Ranking: Give a rank (A, B, C, D, F) at end of level depending on timer
- Collectables: optional items that can be collected

Enemy system:

- Patrol certain areas (move left and right)
- Deal damage on contact
- Gets destroyed when hit with object (dropped/ thrown)

Rules & Constraints:

- Limited range on telekinesis (circle around player)
- Weight on objects (the heavier it is the harder it is to move)
- The player can be harmed by hazards and enemies
- Objects have physics

Resources:

- Player health (based on difficulty)
- Environmental objects

- Collectable items

3.2. Dynamics

Gameplay interactions:

The core gameplay revolves around interacting with movable objects using telekinesis. Players manipulate physics-based objects to solve puzzles, overcome obstacles, and progress through levels. These interactions include lifting, moving, stacking, and throwing objects to activate switches, create paths, and eliminate enemies. The combination of telekinesis and physics-based mechanics allows for multiple solutions to challenges, encouraging creativity and experimentation.

Engagement Overtime:

As the player progresses through the game, new mechanics are gradually introduced, expanding the player's repertoire of abilities. This allows puzzles to become more complex and advanced, requiring greater planning and strategic thinking. In addition, enemies are introduced and become more challenging over time, forcing players to balance puzzle-solving with survival. This increases the overall difficulty by requiring faster decision-making and more precise use of telekinesis. As a result, players are encouraged to learn, adapt, and refine their strategies throughout the game, leading to a sense of progression and mastery.

Emerging Strategies:

Due to the flexibility of the telekinesis system, players can develop a variety of strategies to approach challenges and complete levels. These strategies may include:

- A more aggressive approach by killing all the enemies before doing the puzzles
- A puzzle focus approach by focusing on completing the puzzles while avoiding enemies.
- A speed-based approach by focusing on quickly finishing the level, this can be done by using the telekinesis to move the player, with an object below them to avoid enemies or certain parts of the level.

3.3. Aesthetics

Emotional Experience:

The game is designed to evoke a sense of curiosity as players explore the facility and uncover the secrets behind it, as well as the outside world. It also creates a sense of challenge and satisfaction as players solve increasingly difficult puzzles and progress through the game.

Visual style:

The game features dark, atmospheric environments inspired by a scientific research facility, emphasizing mystery and exploration. A clean 2D art style ensures clarity and readability, allowing players to easily identify interactive objects and navigable areas. Visual effects enhance the telekinesis mechanic, including glowing objects, motion trails, and subtle particle effects when objects are lifted or thrown, providing satisfying visual feedback.

Audio style:

The audio will complement the visual experience, with ambient music to create tension as you explore the facility. Sound effects will provide feedback for player actions and environmental interactions, including telekinesis interactions, object collisions, and enemy movements.

4. Formal Elements

MindShift is a single-player 2D platformer, where the player solves puzzles, manipulates objects with telekinesis, and avoids enemies to progress through each level. The primary goal is to escape the research facility, with the player winning by successfully completing all levels.

Resources include player health, environmental objects, and collectables. Rules limit actions to telekinesis range, object properties, and level constraints. The boundary of the game is entirely contained within the game world. All player actions, interactions, and challenges occur within the levels. The game ends when the player successfully completes all the levels and escapes the facility.

5. Dramatic Elements

Premise:

MindShift follows a character who wakes up alone in a mysterious research facility with no memories. As the player explores, they discover they have telekinetic powers, which are used to manipulate objects, solve puzzles, and interact with the environment. The overarching goal is to escape the facility while uncovering the secrets behind the experiments conducted there.

Characters:

- Main Character: The player-controlled character recently awakened and discovering their telekinetic abilities.
- Enemies: Security drones and experimental creatures that act as obstacles to puzzle-solving and progression.

Story Progression:

Players progress through multiple levels, including test chambers, labs, and security zones. As levels advance, puzzles become more complex, hazards increase, and enemies require strategic use of telekinesis. Clues scattered throughout the facility reveal the story, gradually uncovering the truth about the experiments and the facility's purpose.

6. Dynamic Elements

Dynamic elements in MindShift emerge from the interaction of simple rules, such as the range of telekinesis, object physics, and enemy behaviors. These interactions can produce complex and sometimes unpredictable gameplay, allowing players to experiment with different strategies and approaches to puzzles and hazards. The narrative is also emergent, unfolding as the player explores the facility, discovers clues, and interacts with the environment. Player choices, such as whether to confront or avoid enemies, can influence how challenges are solved and how the story is experienced. Because emergent behaviors are often unpredictable, playtesting is essential to understanding how the game systems interact and how players will experience the gameplay. This ensures that puzzles, hazards, and player abilities combine to create meaningful, engaging, and varied experiences.